Air Blow Gun



Category: **Power Tools & Workshop Machines** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Air pressure gun

What it is used for

An air blow gun directs compressed air to remove loose dust, chips, and debris from suitable work surfaces and equipment. Correct pressure control, safe nozzle use, and appropriate protective equipment help prevent eye injuries, skin penetration, airborne contamination, and equipment damage.

Main parts

- Gun body provides the main hand grip and air passage.
- Trigger controls the airflow.
- Air inlet connects to the compressed-air hose.
- Nozzle directs the air stream.
- Pressure regulator controls supply pressure where fitted.
- Safety nozzle or pressure-limiting feature reduces specified hazards where provided.
- Hose coupling connects the gun to the air supply.
- Hanging hook or holder supports storage where fitted.

Before you start

1. Only trained personnel should use the air blow gun.
2. Inspect the gun, nozzle, trigger, hose, couplings, and pressure regulator for damage or leakage.
3. Confirm the air supply pressure is within the gun and accessory ratings.
4. Check that the nozzle is suitable for the task and has no blockage.
5. Secure the workpiece and remove nearby loose objects that could become projectiles.
6. Wear safety goggles or a face shield and suitable hearing and respiratory protection based on the risk assessment.
7. Use local extraction or another approved cleaning method where airborne dust or hazardous particles may be generated.

How to use

1. Confirm that the compressor and air line are operating within their specified pressure limits.
2. Connect the gun securely to the approved compressed-air hose.
3. Set the regulator to the minimum effective pressure permitted by the task and equipment instructions.
4. Position the nozzle toward the work surface and away from people, yourself, and exposed skin.
5. Hold the gun firmly and operate the trigger in short, controlled bursts.

6. Direct debris toward a suitable collection area or extraction system rather than into the surrounding workspace.
7. Keep the nozzle at a safe distance from the surface and avoid damaging sensitive components.
8. Release the trigger whenever the gun is not actively being used.
9. Close the air supply and depressurise the hose before disconnecting or changing the nozzle.
10. Inspect the cleaned area and equipment, then store the gun and hose safely.

⚠ Safety

- Never direct compressed air at a person, skin, eyes, or clothing.
- Never use compressed air to clean the body or remove dust from clothing.
- Do not use compressed air to clean hazardous dust unless an approved contained procedure specifically permits it.
- Never exceed the rated pressure or bypass a pressure-limiting safety feature.
- Do not use the gun near flammable vapours or in an atmosphere where air movement could create an additional hazard.
- Isolate and depressurise the line before clearing blockages, repairing leaks, or servicing the gun.

Care & storage

- Wipe the exterior with an approved cleaning method after use.
- Inspect the nozzle, trigger, hose, couplings, and seals regularly.
- Keep the nozzle clear without inserting fingers or unapproved tools.
- Store the gun in a clean, dry location away from heat and impact.
- Remove damaged equipment from service and arrange authorised repair.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using excessive air pressure for the task.
- Directing the air stream toward skin or other people.
- Blowing hazardous dust into the air without suitable containment or extraction.
- Disconnecting a pressurised hose or using a damaged nozzle.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.